INCH-POUND

MIL-DTL-17/186C
w/AMENDMENT 1
29 JUNE 2018
SUPERSEDING
MIL-DTL-17/186C
22 May 2014

DETAIL SPECIFICATION SHEET

# CABLE, RADIO FREQUENCY, FLEXIBLE, TWIN, 78 OHMS, M17/186-00001

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

The requirements for acquiring the product described herein shall consist of this specification sheet and MIL-DTL-17.

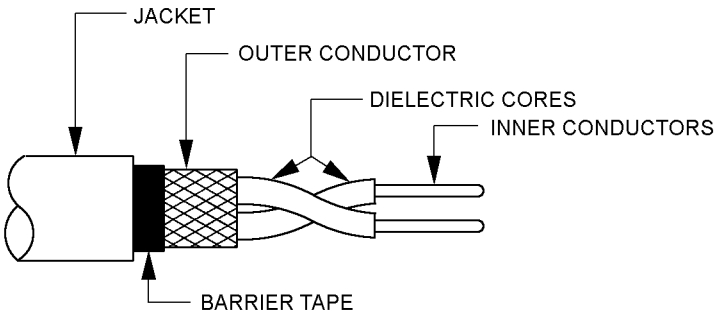



FIGURE 1. Configuration.

TABLE I. Description.

FIGURE 1. Configuration.

TABLE I. Description.

| Components | Construction details |
|---|---|
| Inner conductors | Two conductors. Seven strands of tinned copper wire, each strand .0126 inch diameter. One strand of one conductor shall be bare copper for identification. Overall diameter of each conductor: .0378 inch ± .0020. |
| Dielectric cores | Two cores, twisted together with a right-hand lay of 2 1/2 ± 1/2 inches. Type A-1: Solid polyethylene, each core. Fill-to-round not applicable. Diameter of each core: .079 inch ± .003. |
| Outer conductor | Single braid of AWG No. 36, tinned copper wire. Diameter .180 inch nominal.<br><br>Coverage: 86.8% nominal<br>Carriers: 16<br>Ends: 6<br>Picks/inch: 10.8 ± 10% |
| Barrier tape | A .001 inch thick polyester tape faced with a .002 inch thick layer of aluminum. The tape will be applied with a 50% lap, aluminum face toward the outer conductor. Diameter: .190 inch maximum. |
| Jacket | Cross-linked polyolefin. Diameter of major axis: .235 inch ± .010. Jacket thickness: .018 inch minimum.` |



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-15T16:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

ENGINEERING INFORMATION:

Continuous working voltage: 750 V rms, maximum.
Operating frequency: 10 MHz, maximum.
Velocity of propagation: 65.9 percent, nominal.
Operating temperature range: -30°C to +85°C.
Inner conductor properties:
DC resistance (maximum at +20°C): 1.055 ohms per 100 feet (each conductor).
Elongation: 15 percent, minimum.

Engineering notes: This cable is useful in balance cables applications. These cables were redesigned to meet the vertical flame test.

REQUIREMENTS:

Dimensions, configuration, and descriptions: See figure 1 and table I.
Environmental and mechanical:
Visual and mechanical examination: Applicable.
Diameter: See figure 1 and table I.
Out-of-roundness: Not applicable.
Eccentricity: 10 percent maximum. 1/
Adhesion of conductors: Inner conductor to core: 2 pounds, minimum; 20 pounds, maximum.
Aging stability: +98°C ± 2°C.
Stress crack resistance: Not applicable.
Outer conductor integrity: Not applicable.
Cold bend: -30°C ± 2°C.
Dimensional stability: +85°C ± 2°C
Inner conductor from core: .062 inch, maximum.
Inner conductor from jacket: .125 inch, maximum.
Bendability: Not applicable.
Flammability: Not applicable.
Weight: 4.1 pounds per 100 feet maximum.

1/ ($T_{MAX}$-$T_{MIN}$) shall be interpreted as the difference in total wall thickness measured (1) along a line through the centers of the conductors between the edge of each conductor and the nearest surface of the core and (2) between a line tangent to the two conductors and a parallel line tangent to the surface of the core on both sides of the conductors. The eccentricity corresponding to the larger measured value ($T_{MAX}$-$T_{MIN}$) shall be reported.

Electrical:

Continuity: Applicable.
Spark test: 2,000 V rms, minimum.
Voltage withstanding: 2,000 V rms, minimum.
Insulation resistance: Not applicable.
Corona extinction voltage: Not applicable.
Characteristic impedance: 78 ± 7 ohms. 2/
Attenuation: 2.8 dB per 100 feet maximum, at 10 MHz.
Structural return loss: Not applicable.
Capacitance: 24.5 pF per foot, maximum.

2/ Measure inductance of a 10-foot ± 2 inch test cable at 1 MHz using a suitable test instrument. The shield shall be floated and the conductors shall be shorted at the far end. Calculate the impedance (Z) from the measured inductance (L) and the measured capacitance (C) using the formula:

$$Z = \sqrt{L/C} \text{ ohms}$$



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-15T16:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Capacitance stability: Not applicable.
Capacitance unbalance: 5 percent maximum.

Transmission unbalance: Not applicable.
Mechanically induced noise voltage: Not applicable.
Time delay: Not applicable.
Contamination: Not applicable.
Inductance: Not applicable.
Marking: Not applicable.
Workmanship: Not applicable.

Flame propagation: Applicable.
Acid gas generation: 2.0 percent, maximum.
Halogen content: 0.2 percent, maximum.
Immersion test:
  Tensile strength, percent of unaged minimum: 50
  Elongation, percent of unaged minimum: 50.
Smoke index: 25 maximum.
Toxicity index: 5 maximum.
Durometer hardness: (Type A) 80 minimum.
Weathering: Jacket material shall be tested in accordance with Measurement 3306 of MIL-STD-1678-3.
Abrasion resistance: 75 cycles minimum (jacket only).
Tear strength: 35 pounds per inch minimum.
Heat distortion: 30 percent maximum distortion.
Physical tests on unaged jacket:
  Tensile strength: 1,300 psi, minimum.
  Elongation, 160 percent, minimum.
Physical tests on aged jacket:
  Air oven:
    Tensile strength, percent minimum: 60
    Elongation, percent minimum: 60
  Hot oil immersion:
    Tensile strength, percent minimum: 50
    Elongation, percent minimum: 50
Tensile strength and elongation: 1,300 psi, 160 percent minimum.

Part or Identifying Number (PIN): M17/186-00001.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-15T16:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE I. Qualification and Group A, B, and C Table.

| Group | Qualification inspection | Requirement paragraph | Test paragraph | Qual- # of Specimens | Conf - # of Specimens | Conformance inspection |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| I | In-process inspection: | | 4.5 | Entire sample | | |
| | Continuity | 3.7.1 | 4.8.2 | Entire sample | | |
| | Spark test | 3.7.2 | 4.8.3 | Entire sample | | |
| | Voltage withstanding | 3.7.3 | 4.8.4 | Entire sample | | |
| | Visual and mechanical inspection | 3.6 | 4.8.1 | Entire sample | Per Table VIII | A |
| | Diameter measurements. | 3.6.1 | 4.8.1.1 | Entire sample | Per Table VIII | A |
| | Eccentricity of inner conductor | 3.6.3 | 4.8.1.3 | 2 | Per Table VIII | A |
| | Adhesion of conductors | 3.6.4 | 4.8.1.4 | 4 | Per Table VIII | A |
| | Characteristic impedance | 3.7.6 | 4.8.7 | 1 | Per Table VIII | A |
| II | RF transmission loss (attenuation) | 3.7.7 | 4.8.8 | 2 | Per Table VIII | A |
| | Standing wave ratio (return loss) | 3.7.8 | 4.8.9 | 2 | Per Table VIII | A |
| | | | | | | |
| | Capacitance | 3.7.9 | 4.8.10 | 1 | Per Table VIII | B |
| | Capacitance unbalance | 3.7.11 | 4.8.12 | 1 | Per Table VIII | B |



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-15T16:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE I. Qualification and Group A, B, and C Table - Continued.

| Group | Qualification inspection | Requirement paragraph | Test paragraph | Qual- # of Specimens | Conf - # of Specimens | Conformance inspection |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| II | Aging Stability | 3.7.15 | | | | C |
| | Cold bend | 3.7.18 | 4.8.19 | 3 | Per Table VIII | B |
| | Weight | 3.9 | 4.8.24 | 1 | Per Table VIII | B |
| | Dimensional stability | 3.7.19 | 4.8.20 | 1 | Per Table VIII | C |
| | Flame propagation | 3.7.23 | 4.8.25 | 1 | | |
| | Acid gas generation | 3.7.24 | 4.8.26 | 1 | | |
| | Halogen content | 3.7.25 | 4.8.27 | 1 | | |
| | Immersion | 3.7.26 | 4.8.28 | 1 | | |
| | Smoke index | 3.7.27 | 4.8.29 | 1 | | |
| | Toxicity index | 3.7.28 | 4.8.30 | 1 | | |
| | Durometer hardness | 3.7.29 | 4.8.31 | 1 | | |
| | Weathering | 3.7.30 | 4.8.32 | 1 | | |
| | Abrasion resistance | 3.7.31 | 4.8.33 | 5 | | |
| | Tear strength | 3.7.32 | 4.8.34 | 6 | Per Table VIII | B |
| | Heat distortion | 3.7.33 | 4.8.35 | 1 | Per Table VIII | C |
| | Physicals | 3.7.34 | 4.8.36 | 1 | Per Table VIII | C |
| | Tensile strength and elongation | 3.7.35 | 4.8.37 | 1 | Per Table VIII | C |



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-15T16:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Amendment notations. The margins of this specification are marked with vertical lines to indicate where modifications from this amendment were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations.

Referenced documents. In addition to MIL-DTL-17 this document references the following:

MIL-STD-1678-3

CONCLUDING MATERIAL

Custodians:
Army – CR
Navy – EC
Air Force – 85
DLA - CC

Preparing activity:
DLA-CC

Review activities:
Army – AR, AT, CR4, MI
Navy – AS, MC, OS, SH
Air Force – 19, 99

(Project 6145-2018-038)

NOTE: The activities listed above were interested in this document as of the date of this document. Since organizations and responsibilities can change, you should verify the currency of the information above using the ASSIST Online database at https://assist.dla.mil.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-15T16:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.